SUMMIT INITIATIVE SOLUTIONS

How to publish a blog post

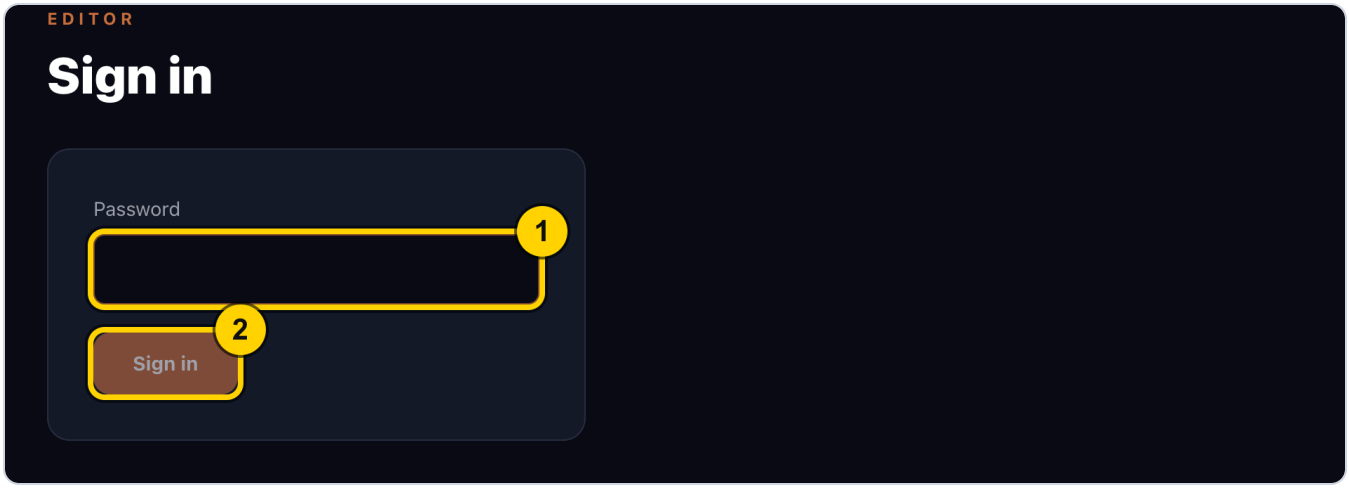
A step-by-step guide to the blog editor on your website. No technical knowledge needed. If you can write an email, you can do this.

> **The short version:** go to `summitinitiativesolutions.com/admin`, sign in with your editor password, click **New post**, write or paste your article, click **Publish**. It is live in a minute or two. Then copy the link and paste it into your LinkedIn post.

In the pictures below, the yellow numbered boxes match the numbered steps in the text.

1. Sign in

1. Open your web browser and go to `https://summitinitiativesolutions.com/admin`. Bookmark it so it is one click next time.
2. (1) Type your editor password.
3. (2) Click **Sign in**.

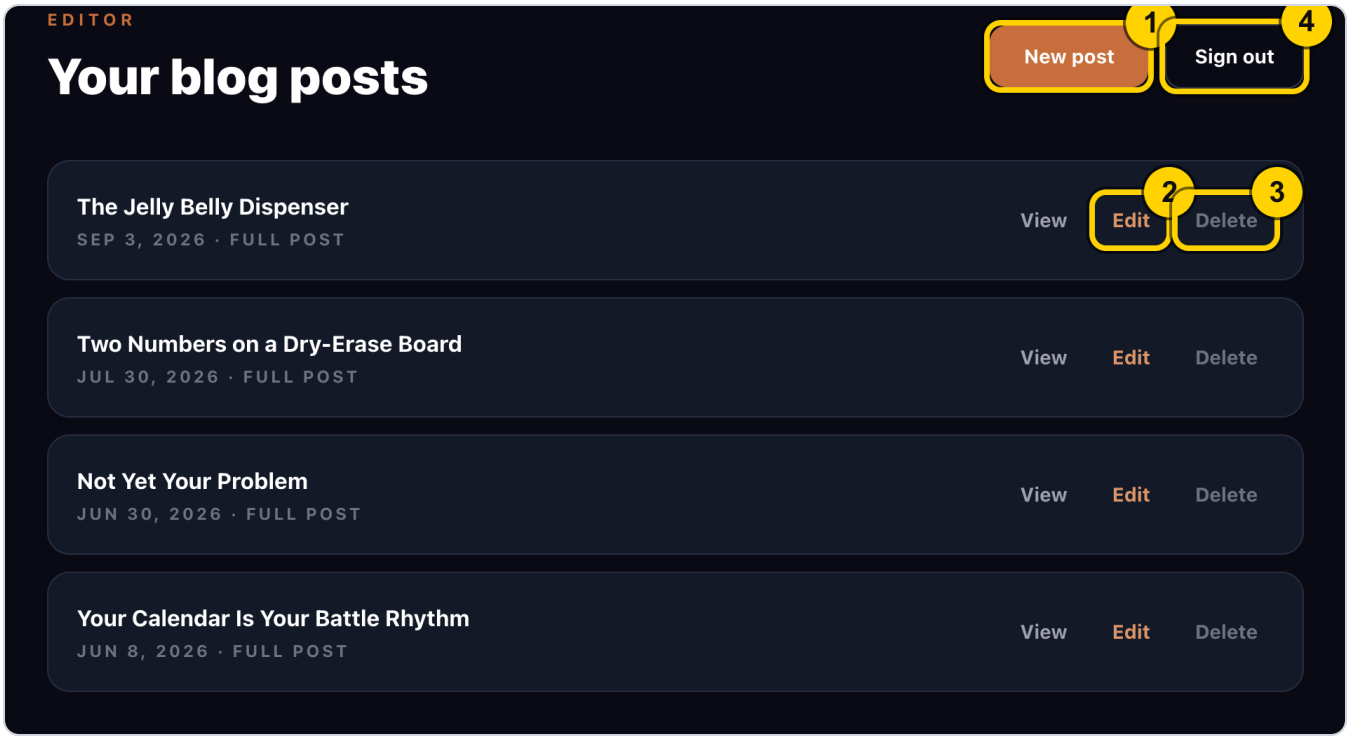


The sign-in screen. Only you can see it, and search engines are told to ignore it.

You stay signed in on that computer for 7 days. On a shared computer, click **Sign out** when you finish.

2. Your list of posts

After signing in you see every post on your blog, newest first.



The dashboard.

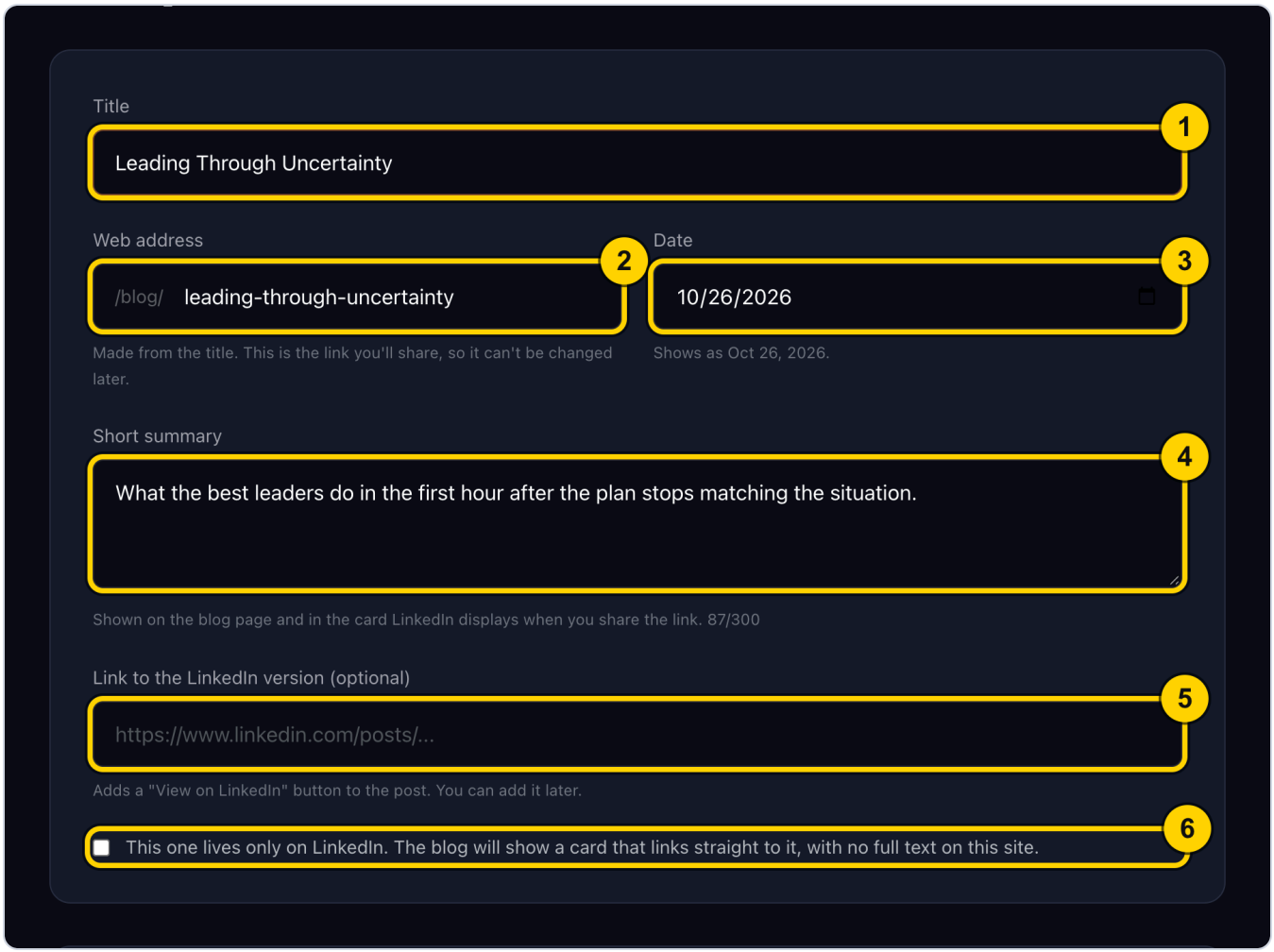
1. 1 **New post** starts a blank article.
2. 2 **Edit** reopens an existing post so you can change it.
3. 3 **Delete** removes a post (you are asked to confirm).
4. 4 **Sign out** ends your session.

View opens the post as the public sees it.

3. Write a new post

Fill in the details

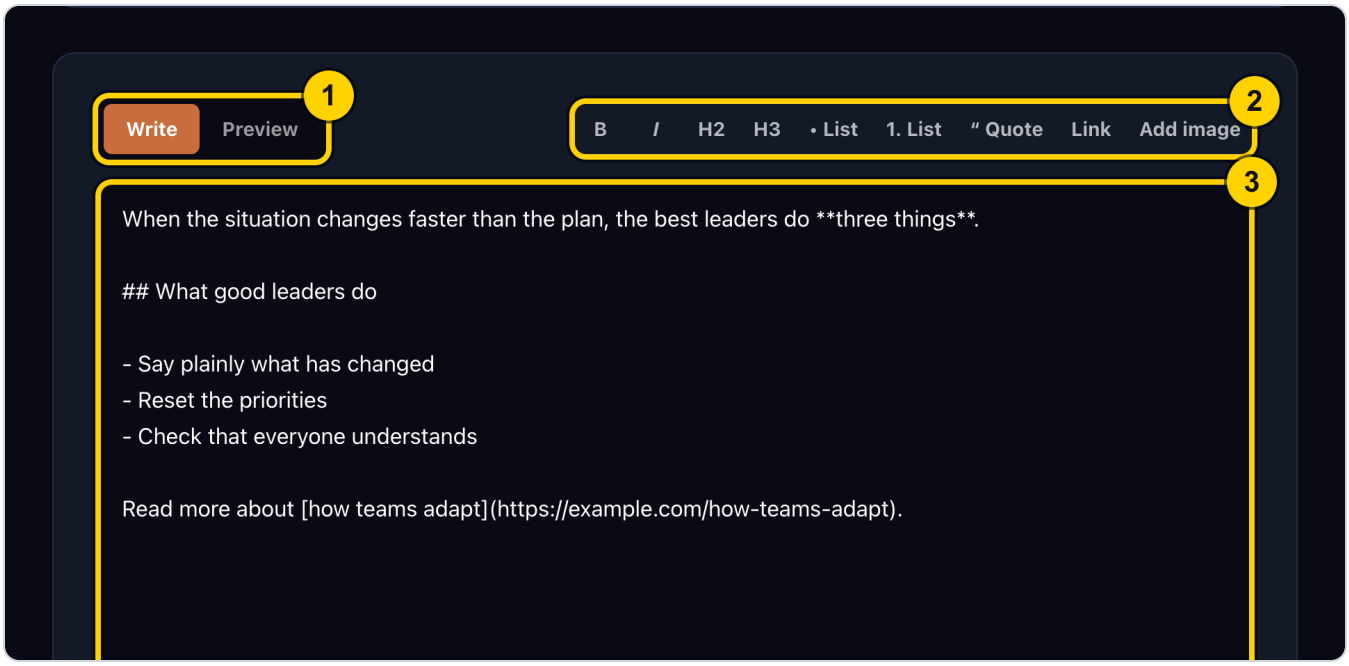
Click **New post**. Start with the boxes at the top.



The post details.

1. 1 **Title.** The headline of your article.
2. 2 **Web address.** Fills in by itself from the title (for example `leading-through-uncertainty`). You normally do not need to touch it. Once published, avoid changing it, because links you have already shared would stop working.
3. 3 **Date.** The date shown on the post. It starts as today. Change it if you are posting something older.
4. 4 **Short summary.** One or two sentences. It appears on the blog page card and in search results.
5. 5 **Link to the LinkedIn version (optional).** If you have already posted a shorter version on LinkedIn, paste its full web address here (it must start with `https://`). Leave it blank otherwise.
6. 6 **Lives only on LinkedIn.** Tick this only when you want the blog page to link out to LinkedIn instead of hosting the full article. Leave it unticked for full posts written here.

Write the article



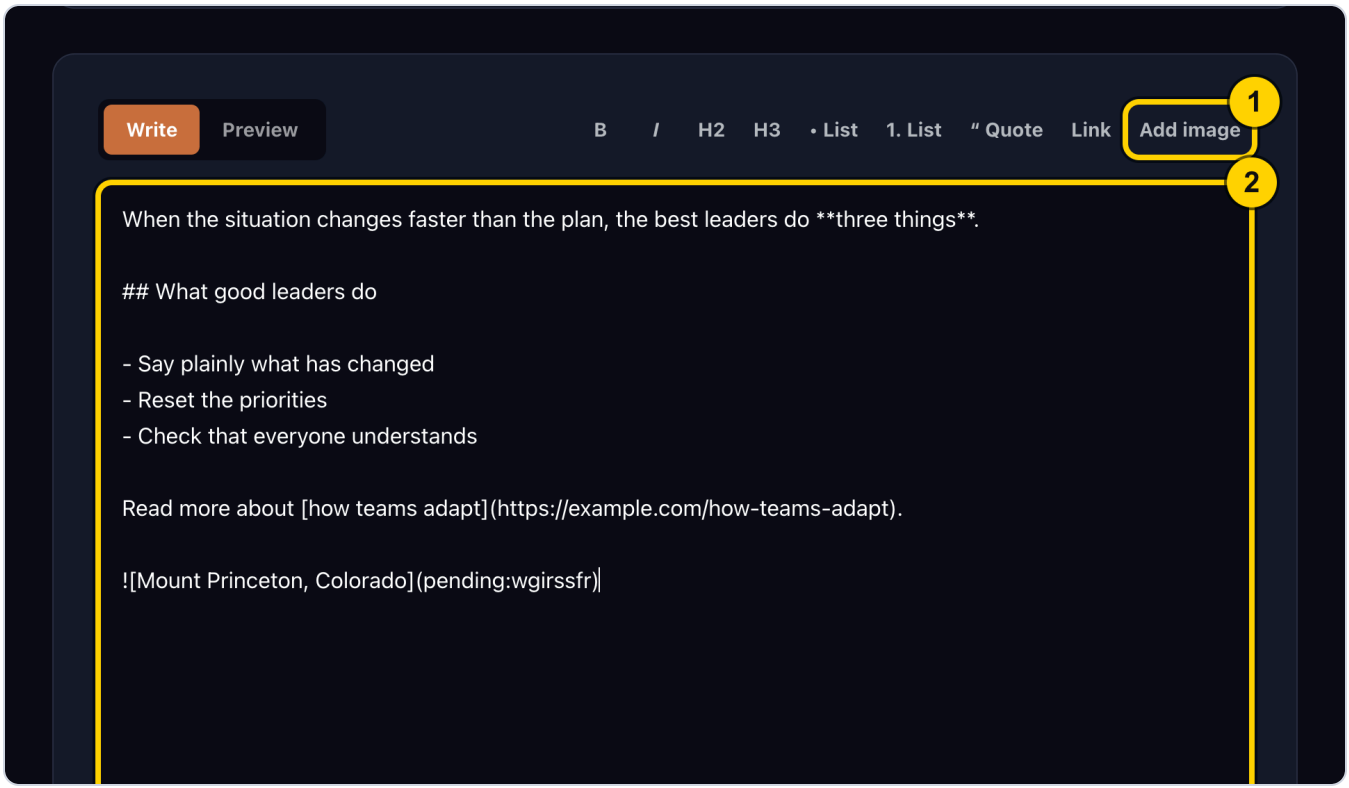
The Write tab.

1. 1 The **Write** and **Preview** tabs switch between typing and seeing the finished look.
2. 2 The buttons above the text box add formatting: **B** bold, *I* italic, **H2**/**H3** headings, bulleted and numbered lists, quote, and Link.
3. 3 Type in the big text box.

Tip: you can paste straight from Word or Google Docs. Headings, bold, italics, lists and links are carried over automatically.

To format text, select the words and click a button, or just click the button and type. You will see small symbols such as `**bold**` in the box; that is normal. The Preview tab shows the real result.

Add a picture

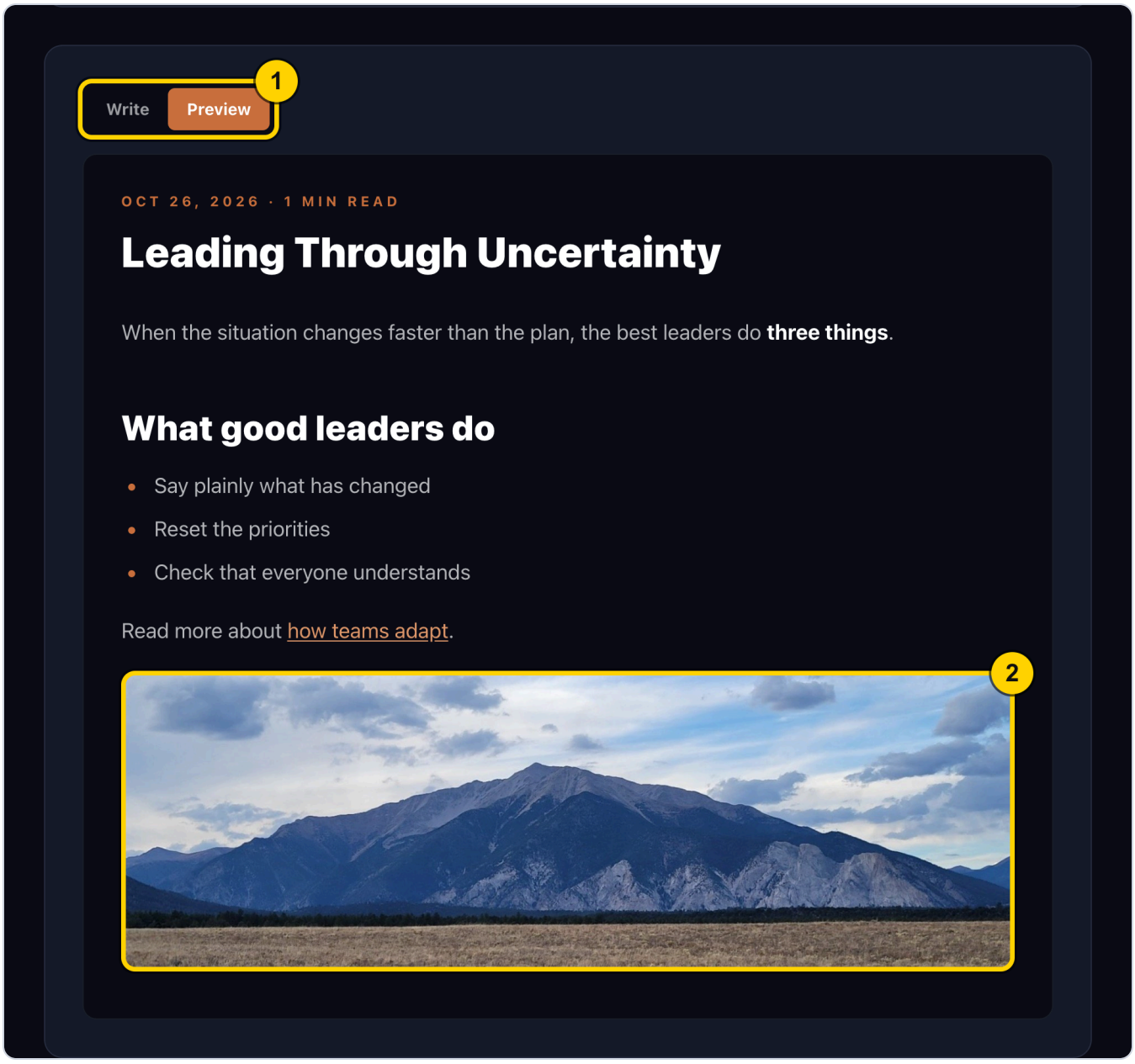


Adding an image.

1. Click in the text where you want the picture to go.
2. 1 Click **Add image** and choose a photo from your computer.
3. A line like `![Describe this image](pending:...)` appears in the text 2 . Replace the words *Describe this image* with a short description of the picture (it helps readers who use screen readers). Leave the rest of the line alone; it turns into the picture when you publish.

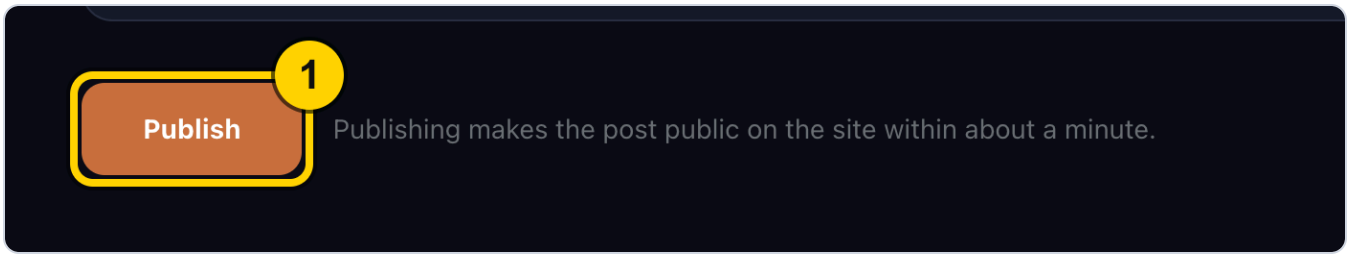
Pictures are shrunk automatically. Supported types are JPG, PNG, GIF and WebP. Up to 12 pictures per post.

4. Preview, then publish



The Preview tab shows what readers will see.

1. (1) Click **Preview** and read it through. Pictures appear here exactly as they will on the site (2).
2. If something is wrong, click **Write** and fix it.

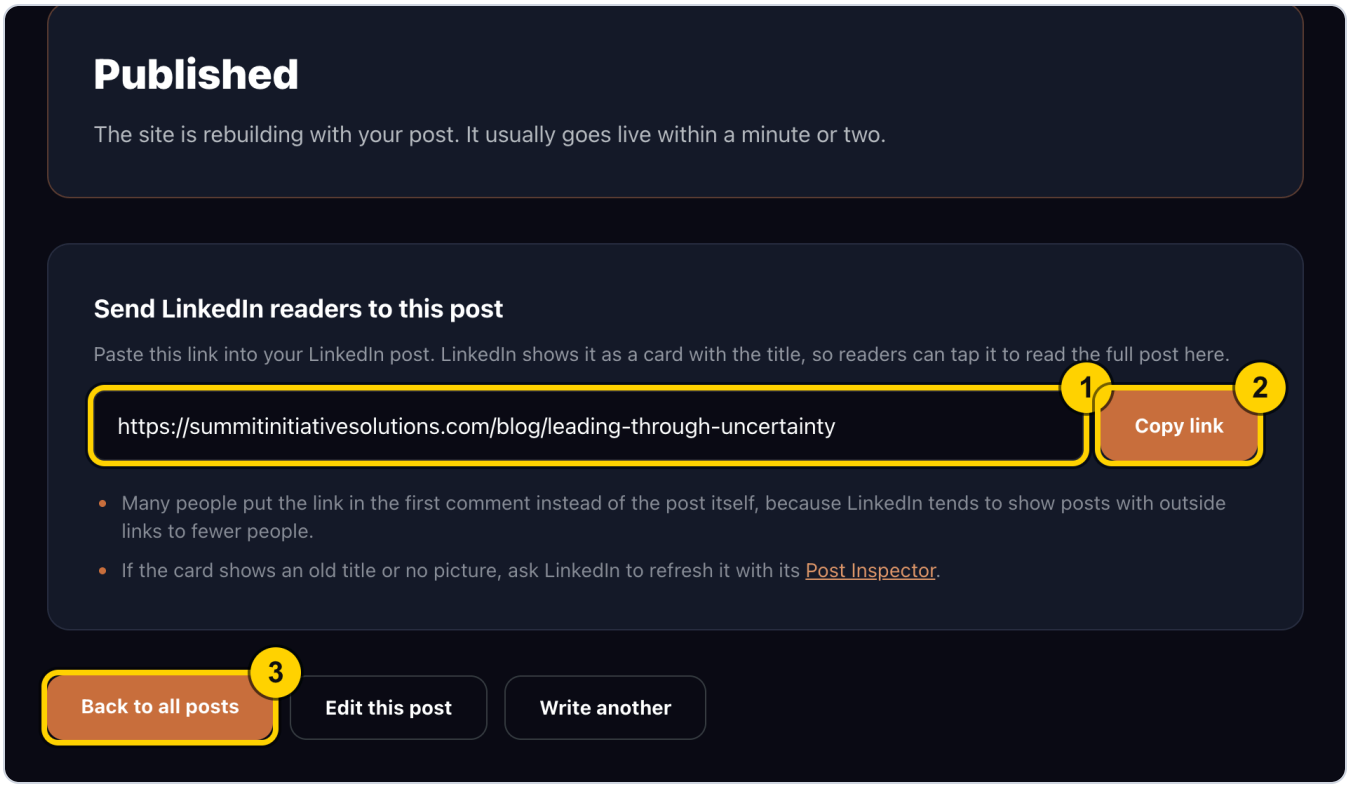


The Publish button is at the bottom of the page.

1. 1 When you are happy, click **Publish**.

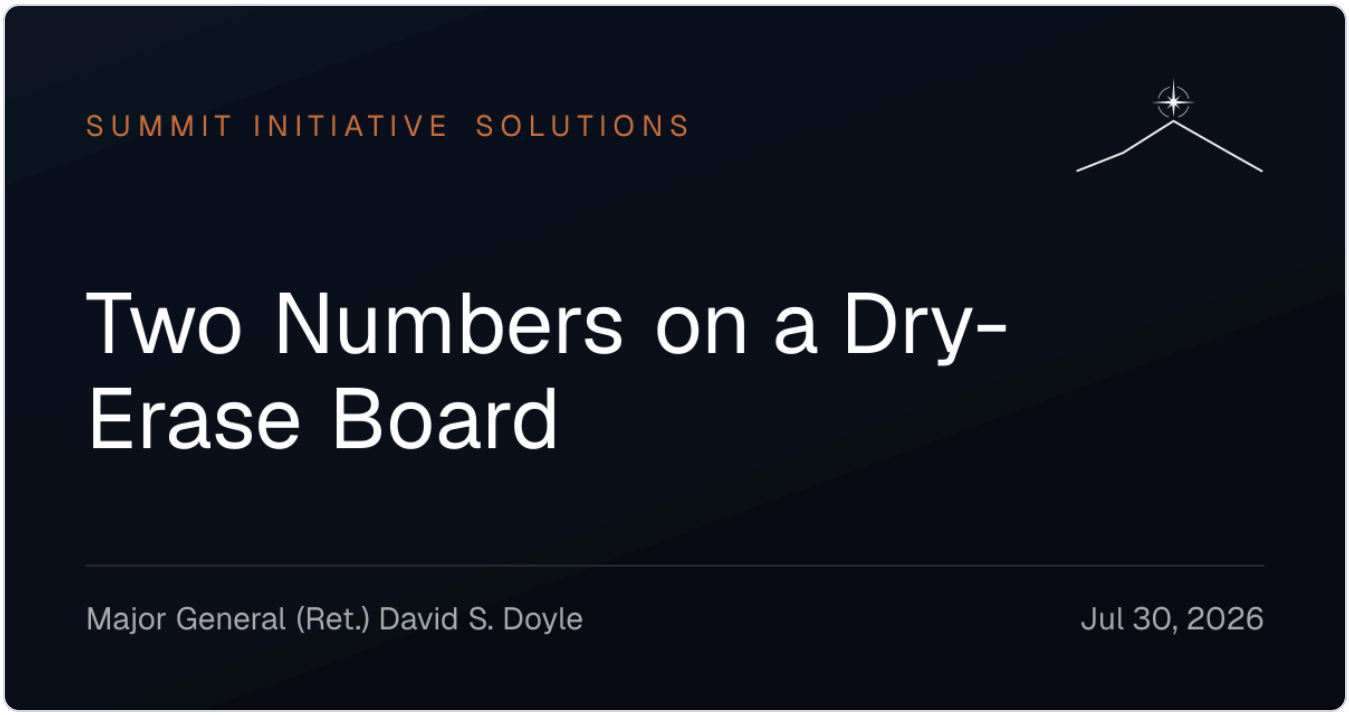
Your writing is saved in your browser as you type, so an accidental refresh or closed tab will not lose it (pictures are not saved in a draft, so you would add them again). Nothing goes public until you click Publish.

5. After publishing: share it on LinkedIn



The confirmation screen.

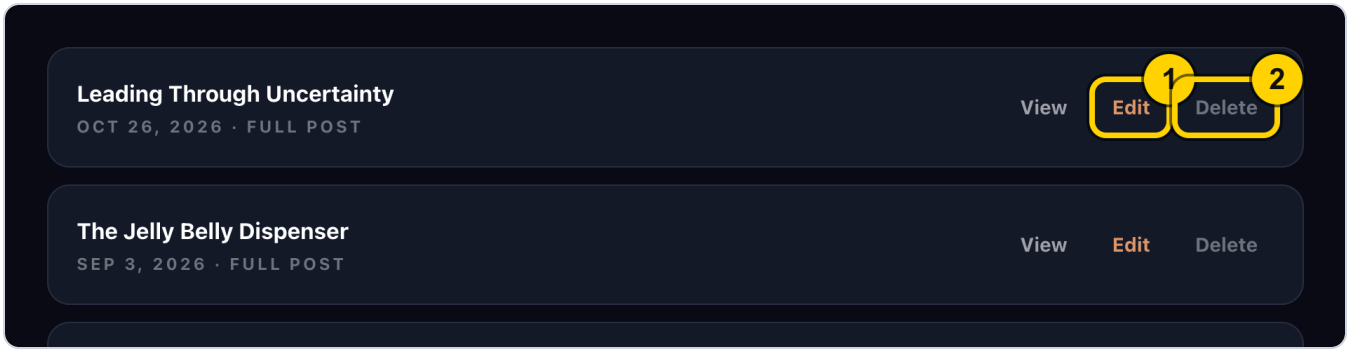
1. The site rebuilds with your post. This takes **one to two minutes**. If the link says "not found" at first, wait a minute and try again.
2. 1 This is the link to your full post on your website.
3. 2 Click **Copy link**.
4. Open LinkedIn, write your shorter post, and paste the link. LinkedIn shows a card with the title and a branded picture. Readers who tap it land on your website.
5. 3 **Back to all posts** returns you to the list.



Example of the card LinkedIn shows for your link (this one is for an existing post).

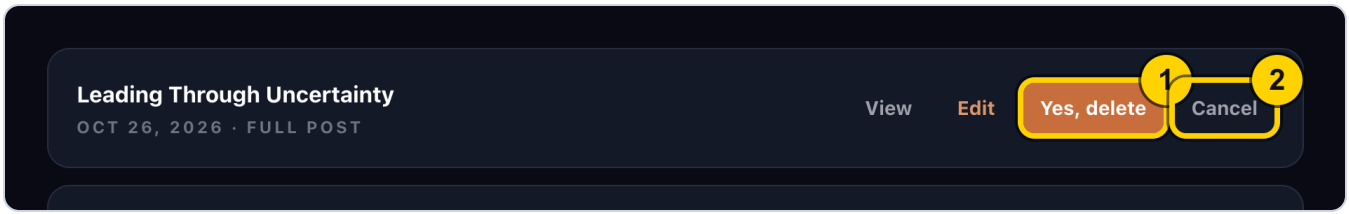
> **Two LinkedIn tips.** Many people paste the link in the first comment instead of the post itself, because LinkedIn tends to show posts with outside links to fewer people. And if the card shows an old title or no picture, use LinkedIn's *Post Inspector* (linked on the confirmation screen) to refresh it.

6. Edit or delete a post



Edit and Delete on the post list.

1. 1 **Edit** opens the post exactly as you left it. Change anything and click **Publish** again to update it. The change is live in a minute or two.
2. 2 **Delete** asks you to confirm.

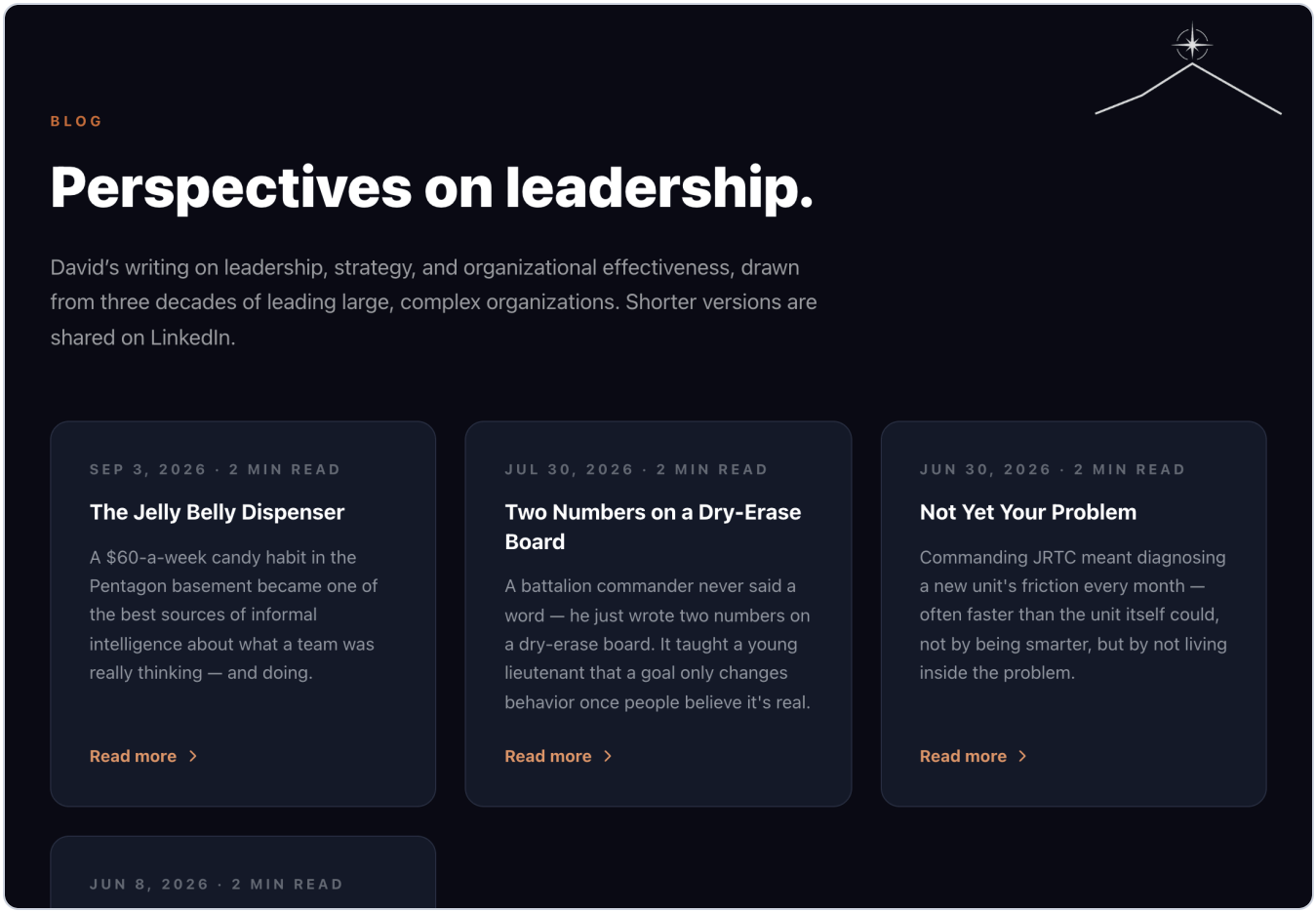


Confirming a delete.

1. **1** **Yes, delete** removes the post from the website.
2. **2** **Cancel** keeps it.

Deleting takes the post off the site within a minute or two. Any LinkedIn post that pointed to it will then show a "page not found", so only delete when you are sure.

7. Where your post appears



The public blog page. New posts show here, newest first.

If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"The editor isn't switched on yet."	The site setup is incomplete. Contact Adam; see the maintainer notes below.
Password is rejected	Check caps lock and try again. After several wrong tries in a row you are locked out for about 15 minutes. If you forgot it, Adam can set a new one.
"Link must start with https://" on the LinkedIn box	Paste the full web address copied from LinkedIn (starting `https://`), or clear the box.
Publish fails or says someone else changed the site	Wait a few seconds and click Publish again. Your text is not lost.
Picture is refused	Use a JPG, PNG, GIF or WebP picture. Each picture must be under about 1.5 MB after shrinking, and a post can hold about 3.8 MB of pictures in total.
My post is not on the blog page yet	Give it two minutes, then refresh. If it is still missing after ten, tell Adam.
Signed out unexpectedly	Sessions last 7 days. Sign in again. Your unfinished text is kept in the browser (pictures are not).

For the site maintainer (Adam)

- **How it works:** Publish writes a Markdown file (and any images) into the GitHub repository `content/posts` using a token. Vercel sees the commit and rebuilds the site (about 1 to 2 minutes). Posts are plain files, so the full history is in GitHub.
- **Vercel environment variables:** `ADMIN_PASSWORD` (12+ characters), `ADMIN_SESSION_SECRET` (16+ random characters), `BLOG_GITHUB_TOKEN`, `BLOG_GITHUB_REPO`, `BLOG_GITHUB_BRANCH`. Changing any of them needs a redeploy before it takes effect.
- **GitHub token:** a fine-grained personal access token limited to this one repository with Contents: read and write. Tokens expire; note the expiry date and renew before then, or publishing will start failing.
- **Changing the password:** update `ADMIN_PASSWORD` in Vercel, then redeploy.
- **Testing locally:** see the README ("Blog and the editor") for `npm test` and the fake GitHub server.